

**“Mitey Mites” for the micro-economy in Uganda,
and all over the world, and to infinity and beyond!**

June 11/24. First day of the Apostles fast. Chinese Martyrs of the Boxer Rebellion.



I am very proud of my little country church! We have a long-standing tradition in our church of collecting for something every single Sunday. We call it our “Mitey Mites” collection. Sometimes it’s \$100, sometimes more. When the children are coming to kiss the cross at the end of the liturgy everyone is carrying a dollar or two or \$10 bill or some change, which their parents have given them. Our children are learning alms giving, and we as a church are impacting people in our backyard, and all over the world. All these “mites” add up quite a bit.



They especially add up when they are given to those who are very poor. Father Christopher Walusimbi’s Matushka Maria is



very sick, and is in great pain. She needs a medical scan and probably surgery. He asked “Orthodox Africa”, of whom I am a board member, for some relief. Fr. Christopher is the pastor of “Holy Annunciation, Orthodox Church, Bukasa Island, Uganda”, which is one of our vetted missions. We recently helped build a chicken coop, which will help them to have operating income. We only finance infrastructure for our vetted missions (and we are always happy to consider adding more!). We believe very much in the Chinese proverb that giving a man a fish only allows him to eat for a day but teaching him, to fish allows them to eat for a lifetime. We don’t give money for operating expenses and personal medical needs, however, of course, while we are building dormitories, and chicken coops and orphanages and drilling wells and such, people need to eat and they have medical emergencies.

Orthodox Africa board members took up collections in two of our churches. Our church gave \$508 which is an extraordinary amount for a single collection, and another gave \$100. It gratifies me very much that when I talk to my family as their pastor, father and friend, they believe me, and they spring into action.



Monster and Ax man!

This morning I had the distinct pleasure of sending by wire transfer \$608 to Father Christopher's bank in a Uganda. Our parish and my personal bank, which is called "Independent Financial", is awesome. They always give excellent service, and the people that I talk to actually know who I am, and ask about my grandchildren. They even smile when I show them pictures! They routinely waive the fees when we send international wire transfers for charities. That saves us and our recipients \$45.

Our little escapade this week and has given me an idea. Who among you is in a church that wants to partner with us and start taking up weekly collections for something, anything? Just don't call it "Mitey Mites": that's our thing! Most the time, you will collect for whatever you wish, but every once in a while, we will partner together, and you will collect for something I ask you to collect for and we will collect for something you ask us to collect for.

We collect every month for St. Barnabas Orthodox orphanage and school, where we are building a dormitory for 180 children. In the meantime, of course the children need to eat and have clothing and medical care and school books etc. We also collect regularly for Orthodox Africa, and the fund for assistance (FFA) and many other worthy causes too numerous to list. If you're interested, contact me.

Certainly, all of our Orthodox Africa board members should be interested!

In poor countries, the micro economy often makes things happen. That micro economy can come from us. Orthodox Africa will work on bigger things, and WE THE PEOPLE will help with smaller things which have to get done also.

<http://www.orthodox.net/journal/2019-06-24+mitey-mites-for-the-micro-economy-in-uganda.pdf>

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Orthodox Africa: <https://orthodoxafrica.org/> FB: [@orthodoxafrica](https://www.facebook.com/orthodoxafrica/) or <https://www.facebook.com/orthodoxafrica/>

The "Chicken Project" & a Birthday: <https://orthodoxafrica.org/news-en/the-chicken-project-a-birthday/>

St Barnabas Orthodox Orphanage & School <https://orthodoxmissionkenya.org/>

Fund for assistance: <https://fundforassistance.org/>

St Nicholas Orthodox Church: <http://www.orthodox.net>

Independent Financial: www.independent-bank.com

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